KINGDOM LIFE MINISTRY

Heaven Comes to Earth

The Prophets, the Tabernacle, and the City That Comes Down

A Midrash Study from Eden to Revelation 22

Scripture quoted from the World English Bible, divine name rendered YHWH, Elohim, and Adonai, with the Son's name rendered Yahshua and Messiah. Part one of two. Companion study: The Resurrection: Our Glorified Bodies.

THE HEART OF IT

Most of us grew up singing about going up to heaven. But read the last two chapters of the Bible slowly and you will notice the direction is the other way. John does not see the saints going up. He sees the city **coming down**.

From the first page of Scripture to the last, YHWH has been after one thing: to dwell with his people, on the earth he made, in a place with no curse. Eden was the start of that plan, the tabernacle was the rehearsal, Yahshua was the down payment, and the New Jerusalem is the finish.

This study traces that thread through the prophets, the Hebrew, and the Septuagint. Its companion, *The Resurrection: Our Glorified Bodies*, shows what kind of bodies we will have when we live there. For where the dead are right now, see our earlier handout, *We Do Not Go Up*.

SECTION I

The Promise in One Passage

> *I saw a new heaven and a new earth: for the first heaven and the first earth have passed away, and the sea is no more. I saw the holy city, New Jerusalem, coming down out of heaven from Elohim, prepared like a bride adorned for her husband. I heard a loud voice out of heaven saying, "Behold, Elohim's dwelling is with people, and he will dwell with them, and they will be his people, and Elohim himself will be with them as their Elohim. He will wipe away every tear from their eyes. Death will be no more; neither will there be mourning, nor crying, nor pain, any more. The first things have passed away." He who sits on the throne said, "Behold, I am making all things new." He said, "Write, for these words of Elohim are faithful and true."*
>
> **REVELATION 21:1-5**

Coming down

John uses the word καταβαίνουσαν, *katabainousan*, coming down. It is a present participle, the picture of something in motion, descending as he watches. He uses it again in Revelation 3:12 and 21:10. Three times in the book, the New Jerusalem is described the same way: it **comes down out of heaven from Elohim**. Not once does the city go up, and not once do the people go up to live in it.

Tabernacle with people

Elohim's dwelling is with people is literally *the tabernacle of Elohim*, ἡ σκηνὴ τοῦ θεοῦ, *hē skēnē tou theou*. And *he will dwell with them* is σκηνώσει, *skēnōsei*, he will tabernacle, he will pitch his tent. This is the same word John used in his Gospel: *The Word became flesh, and lived among us* (John 1:14), ἐσκήνωσεν, *eskēnōsen*, he tabernacled among us. What Yahshua did for thirty three years in one body, the Father does forever in a whole city.

New, not replaced

The word for *new* is καινός, *kainos*. Greek has two words for new. *Neos* means new in time, recent. *Kainos* means new in kind and quality, renewed. Paul uses the same word in 2 Corinthians 5:17: *if anyone is in Messiah, he is a new creation*. When a person is made new in Messiah, he is still the same person, made over. That is the picture here. And YHWH's own words in verse 5 are not *I am making all new things*. They are *I am making all things new*.

SECTION II

It Started on the Earth

> *YHWH Elohim planted a garden eastward, in Eden, and there he put the man whom he had formed. Out of the ground YHWH Elohim made every tree to grow that is pleasant to the sight, and good for food, including the tree of life in the middle of the garden and the tree of the knowledge of good and evil.*
> **GENESIS 2:8-9**

The first home YHWH built for man was not in the clouds. It was a garden, planted with his own hands, on the earth. The Septuagint calls that garden παράδεισος, *paradeisos*, the word we get *paradise* from. Hold onto that word. It will come back.

> *They heard YHWH Elohim's voice walking in the garden in the cool of the day, and the man and his wife hid themselves from the presence of YHWH Elohim among the trees of the garden.*
> **GENESIS 3:8**

Walking here is מתהלך, *mithalekh*, from *halak* in a form that means walking about, going to and fro. YHWH was not visiting Eden. He was at home in it. Then sin came, man was sent out, and cherubim were set to guard the way to the tree of life (Genesis 3:22-24). Paradise was closed.

Now look at how the Bible ends. The tree of life is *in the Paradise of my Elohim* (Revelation 2:7), and Revelation 22 puts that tree beside the river in the street of the New Jerusalem. Paradise is not abolished. It comes back, and it comes back to the earth.

IN GENESIS / IN REVELATION

In Genesis: A garden planted on the earth (Genesis 2:8)
In Revelation: A city coming down to a new earth (Revelation 21:2)

In Genesis: A river goes out of Eden to water the garden (Genesis 2:10)
In Revelation: A river of the water of life flows from the throne (Revelation 22:1)

In Genesis: The tree of life in the middle of the garden (Genesis 2:9)
In Revelation: The tree of life on both sides of the river (Revelation 22:2)

In Genesis: The ground is cursed (Genesis 3:17)
In Revelation: There will be no curse any more (Revelation 22:3)

In Genesis: Man hides from his presence (Genesis 3:8)
In Revelation: They will see his face (Revelation 22:4)

In Genesis: The way to the tree is guarded (Genesis 3:24)
In Revelation: The gates will never be shut (Revelation 21:25)

In Genesis: Death enters (Genesis 2:17; 3:19)
In Revelation: Death will be no more (Revelation 21:4)

> **SAY IT PLAINLY**
>
> The story of the Bible is not man escaping the earth. It is YHWH **restoring** the earth and coming home to it. Revelation is Genesis with the curse taken off.

SECTION III

The Thread of the Tabernacle

Between Eden and the New Jerusalem, YHWH never stopped saying the same thing: *I want to dwell with you.* Follow the word through the whole Bible.

> *Let them make me a sanctuary, that I may dwell among them. According to all that I show you, the pattern of the tabernacle, and the pattern of all of its furniture, even so you shall make it.*
> **EXODUS 25:8-9**

Dwell is שכן, *shakan*, to settle, to abide, to live as a neighbor. *Tabernacle* is משכן, *mishkan*, from the same root: the dwelling place. And he tells Moses why he brought Israel out of Egypt in the first place:

> *I will dwell among the children of Israel, and will be their Elohim. They shall know that I am YHWH their Elohim, who brought them out of the land of Egypt, that I might dwell among them: I am YHWH their Elohim.*
> **EXODUS 29:45-46**

The exodus was not only a rescue *from* Egypt. It was a rescue *to* something: *that I might dwell among them*. The goal of redemption has always been his presence.

> *I will set my tent among you, and my soul won't abhor you. I will walk among you, and will be your Elohim, and you will be my people.*
> **LEVITICUS 26:11-12**

I will walk among you is והתהלכתי, *vehithhalakhti*, the very same walking about form used of YHWH in the garden in Genesis 3:8. In the instructions YHWH gave at Sinai, he promised to walk among his people the way he walked in Eden.

A SEPTUAGINT NOTE, HONESTLY

We prefer the Septuagint where it adds light, so here is one place it does not. In Leviticus 26:11 the Septuagint reads *I will set my covenant* (διαθήκην) where the Hebrew says *my tabernacle* (משכני). The Hebrew is the stronger witness to the dwelling thread in this verse. The Septuagint picks the thread right back up in Ezekiel.

> *Moreover I will make a covenant of peace with them. It will be an everlasting covenant with them. I will place them, multiply them, and will set my sanctuary among them forever more. My tent also will be with them. I will be their Elohim, and they will be my people. The nations will know that I am YHWH who sanctifies Israel, when my sanctuary is among them forever more." ' "*
> **EZEKIEL 37:26-28**

Here the Septuagint uses κατασκήνωσις, *kataskēnōsis*, my tabernacling, from the same family as Revelation 21:3. And notice what comes right before it. Ezekiel 37:15-22 is the two sticks: Judah and Joseph joined into one stick in YHWH's hand, *one nation in the land, no longer two nations*. **The two houses are reunited, and then YHWH sets his tabernacle among them forever.** The regathering of all Israel and the dwelling of YHWH belong to the same promise.

Genesis 3:8 YHWH walks in the garden among his people.

Exodus 25:8 Make me a sanctuary, that I may dwell among them.

Exodus 29:45-46 I brought them out of Egypt that I might dwell among them.

Leviticus 26:11-12 I will set my tabernacle among you and walk among you.

1 Kings 8:27 Solomon asks: will Elohim in very deed dwell on the earth?

Ezekiel 37:27 My tabernacle will be with them, after the two houses are one.

Ezekiel 43:7 The place of my throne, where I will dwell among Israel forever.

John 1:14 The Word became flesh and tabernacled among us.

2 Corinthians 6:16 Paul quotes the promise: I will dwell in them and walk in them.

Revelation 21:3 The tabernacle of Elohim is with people. He will dwell with them.

SOLOMON'S QUESTION GETS ITS ANSWER

At the dedication of the Temple Solomon asked, *But will Elohim in very deed dwell on the earth?* (1 Kings 8:27). Revelation 21:3 is the answer, a thousand years and more in the making: **Yes. Behold, the tabernacle of Elohim is with people.**

Sukkot is the rehearsal

This is why the Feast of Tabernacles matters so much. In the Septuagint the feast is called ἑορτὴ σκηνῶν, *heortē skēnōn*, the feast of tabernacles (Leviticus 23:34), the same tent word as Revelation 21:3. Every year when we live in temporary dwellings and rejoice before YHWH, we are rehearsing the day he moves in for good. And Zechariah says that in the Kingdom the nations will go up year by year to keep this very feast:

> *It will happen that everyone who is left of all the nations that came against Jerusalem will go up from year to year to worship the King, YHWH of Armies, and to keep the feast of booths.*
> **ZECHARIAH 14:16**

SECTION IV

What the Prophets Saw

John did not invent the New Jerusalem. Almost every detail he records had already been promised by the prophets. Read them side by side and you can see Revelation 21 and 22 being drawn line by line out of the Tanakh.

Isaiah

> *"For, behold, I create new heavens and a new earth; and the former things will not be remembered, nor come into mind. But be glad and rejoice forever in that which I create; for, behold, I create Jerusalem to be a delight, and her people a joy. I will rejoice in Jerusalem, and delight in my people; and the voice of weeping and the voice of crying will be heard in her no more.*
> **ISAIAH 65:17-19**

New here is חדשים, *chadashim*, and *create* is ברא, *bara*, the word from Genesis 1:1. The One who created the heavens and the earth in the beginning creates them new at the end. And notice what he creates in them: **Jerusalem**. The city is the center of the new creation. Isaiah 66:22 adds that the new heavens and new earth *shall remain*.

> *The sun will be no more your light by day; nor will the brightness of the moon give light to you, but YHWH will be your everlasting light, and your Elohim will be your glory. Your sun will not go down any more, nor will your moon withdraw itself; for YHWH will be your everlasting light, and the days of your mourning will end.*
> **ISAIAH 60:19-20**

> *"You afflicted, tossed with storms, and not comforted, behold, I will set your stones in beautiful colors, and lay your foundations with sapphires. I will make your pinnacles of rubies, your gates of sparkling jewels, and all your walls of precious stones.*
> **ISAIAH 54:11-12**

> *He has swallowed up death forever! Adonai YHWH will wipe away tears from off all faces. He will take the reproach of his people away from off all the earth, for YHWH has spoken it.*
> **ISAIAH 25:8**

> *It shall happen in the latter days, that the mountain of YHWH's house shall be established on the top of the mountains, and shall be raised above the hills; and all nations shall flow to it. Many peoples shall go and say, "Come, let's go up to the mountain of YHWH, to the house of the Elohim of Jacob; and he will teach us of his ways, and we will walk in his paths." For the Torah shall go out of Zion, and YHWH's word from Jerusalem.*
> **ISAIAH 2:2-3**

Ezekiel

> *He said to me, "Son of man, this is the place of my throne, and the place of the soles of my feet, where I will dwell among the children of Israel forever. The house of Israel will no more defile my holy name, neither they, nor their kings, by their prostitution, and by the dead bodies of their kings in their high places;*
> **EZEKIEL 43:7**

The place of the soles of my feet. YHWH speaks of standing on the earth, among his people, forever. Ezekiel is also carried to *a very high mountain* where he sees the frame of a city (Ezekiel 40:2), just as John is carried to *a great and high mountain* to see the holy city (Revelation 21:10).

> *By the river on its bank, on this side and on that side, will grow every tree for food, whose leaf won't wither, neither will its fruit fail. It will produce new fruit every month, because its waters issue out of the sanctuary. Its fruit will be for food, and its leaf for healing."*
> **EZEKIEL 47:12**

Ezekiel 48:30-34 even names the twelve gates of the city after the twelve tribes of Israel, three on each side, exactly as Revelation 21:12-13 does. And then the closing line of the whole book:

> *"It shall be eighteen thousand reeds around: and the name of the city from that day shall be, 'YHWH is there.'*
> **EZEKIEL 48:35**

In Hebrew, יהוה שמה, **YHWH Shammah**, YHWH is there. That is not only the city's name. It is the whole point of the city.

Daniel

> *Then the iron, the clay, the bronze, the silver, and the gold were broken in pieces together, and became like the chaff of the summer threshing floors. The wind carried them away, so that no place was found for them. The stone that struck the image became a great mountain, and filled the whole earth.*
> **DANIEL 2:35**

> *"In the days of those kings the Elohim of heaven will set up a kingdom which will never be destroyed, nor will its sovereignty be left to another people; but it will break in pieces and consume all these kingdoms, and it will stand forever.*
> **DANIEL 2:44**

The stone cut without hands does not carry the saints off the earth. It **fills the whole earth**. And Daniel 7:27 says the kingdom *under the whole sky* is given to the people of the saints of the Most High. Under the sky is on the earth.

Joel, Zechariah, and Habakkuk

> *His feet will stand in that day on the Mount of Olives, which is before Jerusalem on the east; and the Mount of Olives will be split in two, from east to west, making a very great valley. Half of the mountain will move toward the north, and half of it toward the south.*
> **ZECHARIAH 14:4**

> *It will happen in that day, that living waters will go out from Jerusalem: half of them toward the eastern sea, and half of them toward the western sea. It will be so in summer and in winter. YHWH will be King over all the earth. In that day YHWH will be one, and his name one.*
> **ZECHARIAH 14:8-9**

> *Sing and rejoice, daughter of Zion; for, behold, I come, and I will dwell within you,' says YHWH. Many nations shall join themselves to YHWH in that day, and shall be my people; and I will dwell among you, and you shall know that YHWH of Armies has sent me to you.*
> **ZECHARIAH 2:10-11**

Joel 3:17-18 sees YHWH *dwelling in Zion* with a fountain flowing out of his house. Zechariah 8:3 hears him say *I have returned to Zion, and will dwell in the middle of Jerusalem*. And Habakkuk 2:14 promises that *the earth will be filled with the knowledge of YHWH's glory, as the waters cover the sea*, echoing YHWH's oath in Numbers 14:21. The glory is headed for the earth.

The Psalms

> *The righteous shall inherit the land, and live in it forever.*
> **PSALM 37:29**

> *The heavens are YHWH's heavens, but he has given the earth to the children of men.*
> **PSALM 115:16**

Yahshua quoted Psalm 37 in the Sermon on the Mount: *Blessed are the gentle, for they shall inherit the earth* (Matthew 5:5). The reward for the meek is not a cloud. It is the land.

Line by line: the prophets and Revelation

THE PROPHETS SAID / JOHN SAW
The Prophets Said: New heavens and a new earth (Isaiah 65:17; 66:22) **John Saw:** A new heaven and a new earth (Revelation 21:1)
The Prophets Said: Weeping and crying heard no more (Isaiah 65:19); tears wiped away (Isaiah 25:8) **John Saw:** He will wipe away every tear; no mourning, crying, or pain (Revelation 21:4)
The Prophets Said: Carried to a very high mountain to see a city (Ezekiel 40:2) **John Saw:** Carried to a great and high mountain to see the city (Revelation 21:10)
The Prophets Said: Twelve gates named for the tribes, three on each side (Ezekiel 48:31-34) **John Saw:** Twelve gates with the names of the twelve tribes, three on each side (Revelation 21:12-13)

The Prophets Said: Foundations of sapphires, gates of jewels (Isaiah 54:11-12)
John Saw: Foundations of precious stones, gates of pearl (Revelation 21:19-21)

The Prophets Said: No sun or moon; YHWH your everlasting light (Isaiah 60:19-20)
John Saw: No need of sun or moon; the glory of Elohim lights it (Revelation 21:23)

The Prophets Said: Gates open continually, nations bring their wealth (Isaiah 60:11)
John Saw: Gates never shut; the nations bring their glory into it (Revelation 21:24-26)

The Prophets Said: Waters flow from the house; trees for food and healing (Ezekiel 47:1, 12)
John Saw: River from the throne; tree of life, leaves for healing (Revelation 22:1-2)

The Prophets Said: Living waters go out from Jerusalem (Zechariah 14:8)
John Saw: Water of life, clear as crystal (Revelation 22:1)

The Prophets Said: YHWH Shammah, YHWH is there (Ezekiel 48:35)
John Saw: The tabernacle of Elohim is with people (Revelation 21:3)

SECTION V

What Yahshua and the Apostles Taught

> *Let your Kingdom come. Let your will be done on earth as it is in heaven.*
> **MATTHEW 6:10**

Yahshua taught us to pray for the Kingdom to **come**, not for us to go. The direction of the prayer is heaven toward earth.

In Matthew 19:28 he calls that day παλιγγενεσία, *palingenesia*, the regeneration, the birth again of the world, when the Son of Man sits on his glorious throne and the twelve sit on twelve thrones judging the twelve tribes of Israel. Peter preached the same word picture in the Temple:

> *whom heaven must receive until the times of restoration of all things, which Elohim spoke long ago by the mouth of his holy prophets.*
> **ACTS 3:21**

Restoration is ἀποκατάστασις, *apokatastasis*, putting something back the way it is supposed to be. Heaven holds Yahshua *until* the restoration, and that restoration is exactly what the holy prophets spoke about. Everything in Section IV is what Peter means.

> *For the creation waits with eager expectation for the children of Elohim to be revealed. For the creation was subjected to vanity, not of its own will, but because of him who subjected it, in hope that the creation itself also will be delivered from the bondage of decay into the liberty of the glory of the children of Elohim. For we know that the whole creation groans and travails in pain together until now.*
> **ROMANS 8:19-22**

Paul says creation itself is waiting, groaning like a woman in labor. Creation is not waiting to be thrown away. It is waiting to be **delivered**, set free into the same glory as the children of Elohim. The earth gets a resurrection too.

A city prepared, waiting to come down

> *For he looked for the city which has the foundations, whose builder and maker is Elohim.*
> **HEBREWS 11:10**

> *But now they desire a better country, that is, a heavenly one. Therefore Elohim is not ashamed of them, to be called their Elohim, for he has prepared a city for them.*
> **HEBREWS 11:16**

Abraham looked for a city. Hebrews 13:14 says we seek the city *which is to come*. Galatians 4:26 calls it *the Jerusalem that is above*, and Hebrews 12:22 *the heavenly Jerusalem*. It is heavenly in its origin, prepared above right now. But its destination is here. That is what Yahshua meant when he said he was going to prepare a place:

> *In my Father's house are many homes. If it weren't so, I would have told you. I am going to prepare a place for you. If I go and prepare a place for you, I will come again, and will receive you to myself; that where I am, you may be there also.*
> **JOHN 14:2-3**

Notice who travels. *I will come again, and will receive you to myself*. He comes. The angels at the ascension said the same: *This Yahshua... will come back in the same way as you saw him going into the sky* (Acts 1:11).

Citizens of heaven, waiting for the King

> *For our citizenship is in heaven, from where we also wait for a Savior, Adonai Yahshua Messiah, who will change the body of our humiliation to be conformed to the body of his glory, according to the working by which he is able even to subject all things to himself.*
> **PHILIPPIANS 3:20-21**

Citizenship is πολίτευμα, *politeuma*. Philippi was a Roman colony: its people held Roman citizenship while living far from Rome, and they lived by Rome's ways right where they were. Paul says our citizenship is in heaven, *from where we also wait for a Savior*. We do not wait to go there. We wait for him to come from there, and when he comes, he changes our bodies. That is the subject of our companion study.

> *and made us kings and priests to our Elohim, and we will reign on the earth."*
> **REVELATION 5:10**

> *But, according to his promise, we look for new heavens and a new earth, in which righteousness dwells.*
> **2 PETER 3:13**

Dwells in 2 Peter 3:13 is κατοικεῖ, *katoikei*, settles down and makes a permanent home. Righteousness is not visiting the new earth. It moves in.

SECTION VI

Two Comings Down: The King, Then the City

Getting the order right is half of this teaching. Scripture describes the Kingdom arriving on the earth in two stages. First the King comes down and reigns on the earth. Then, after the thousand years and the final judgment, the city comes down to a renewed earth.

1. **The King returns.** After the tribulation, the sign of the Son of Man appears, and he comes on the clouds (Matthew 24:29-30). His feet stand on the Mount of Olives (Zechariah 14:4; Acts 1:11).
2. **The trumpet and the resurrection.** The dead in Messiah rise and the living are changed (Matthew 24:31; 1 Thessalonians 4:16-17; 1 Corinthians 15:52). This is the first resurrection (Revelation 20:5-6). See the companion handout for what our bodies will be.
3. **The reign on the earth.** The saints reign with Messiah a thousand years (Revelation 20:4-6). The instructions go out of Zion, swords become plowshares (Isaiah 2:2-4), YHWH is King over all the earth (Zechariah 14:9), and the nations keep Sukkot (Zechariah 14:16).
4. **The final rebellion and judgment.** Satan is loosed and destroyed; the great white throne; death and hades are thrown into the lake of fire (Revelation 20:7-15).
5. **New heavens and new earth.** The first things pass away and all things are made new (Revelation 21:1, 5; Isaiah 65:17).
6. **The city comes down.** The New Jerusalem descends out of heaven from Elohim, prepared as a bride (Revelation 21:2, 10).
7. **Elohim dwells with his people.** No temple, no sun, no curse, no night. They see his face and reign forever and ever (Revelation 21:3, 22-23; 22:3-5).

This matches the sequence in our *We Do Not Go Up* handout. The day and hour are not given (Matthew 24:36; Acts 1:7), so we teach the order and refuse to set a date.

SECTION VII

Renewed, Not Thrown Away

Someone will ask: does Peter not say the earth will be burned up? Here is the verse as the WEB has it:

> *But the day of Adonai will come as a thief in the night; in which the heavens will pass away with a great noise, and the elements will be dissolved with fervent heat, and the earth and the works that are in it will be burned up.*
> **2 PETER 3:10**

There is a real textual question in the last line. Many later Greek manuscripts, followed by the KJV and the WEB, read κατακαήσεται, *katakaēsetai*, *will be burned up*. But the oldest manuscripts, and the critical Greek editions, read εὑρεθήσεται, *heurethēsetai*, *will be found*, meaning laid bare, exposed for judgment. Several modern translations follow that older reading.

Peter also gives us the key to read it. A few verses earlier he says the world that then existed *perished*, being overflowed with water (2 Peter 3:6). The flood did not annihilate the planet. It purged it, and Noah stepped back out onto the same ground. Peter uses that judgment as the model for the next one: a fire that purifies, and then a new heavens and new earth *where righteousness dwells*.

> **PUT IT TOGETHER**
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> Kainos, new in quality (Revelation 21:1). Creation *delivered*, not discarded (Romans 8:21). The *restoration* of all things (Acts 3:21). The *regeneration* (Matthew 19:28). Every word Scripture uses points the same way: **YHWH is not finished with the earth. He is going to fix it.**

SECTION VIII

The City Itself

> *One of the seven angels who had the seven bowls, who were loaded with the seven last plagues came, and he spoke with me, saying, "Come here. I will show you the wife, the Lamb's bride." He carried me away in the Spirit to a great and high mountain, and showed me the holy city, Jerusalem, coming down out of heaven from Elohim, having the glory of Elohim. Her light was like a most precious stone, as if it were a jasper stone, clear as crystal;*
> **REVELATION 21:9-11**

1. The city is a bride.

The angel says *come, I will show you the bride*, and then shows John a city. The people are the city and the city is the people. This is where our marriage teachings land. Everything we taught in *Husbands, Love Your Wives* and *Wives, Submit to Your Husbands* points here: the Bridegroom who gave himself up, and the bride who made herself ready (Revelation 19:7-8), finally together in one home.

2. The whole city is the Most Holy Place.

The city is measured at twelve thousand stadia, σταδίων δώδεκα χιλιάδων, its *length, width, and height are equal* (Revelation 21:16). Twelve thousand stadia is roughly fourteen hundred miles on a side. Only one other room in Scripture is a perfect cube: the inner sanctuary of Solomon's Temple, twenty cubits long, twenty wide, and twenty high, overlaid with pure gold (1 Kings 6:20). That was the Most Holy Place, where the ark sat and only the high priest entered once a year. **In the New Jerusalem, the whole city is the Holy of Holies, overlaid with gold, and all of his people live in it.**

> *Within the inner sanctuary was twenty cubits in length, and twenty cubits in width, and twenty cubits in its height; and he overlaid it with pure gold.*
> **1 KINGS 6:20**

That is why verse 22 says what it says:

> *I saw no temple in it, for Adonai Elohim, the Almighty, and the Lamb, are its temple. The city has no need for the sun or moon to shine, for the very glory of Elohim illuminated it, and its lamp is the Lamb.*
> **REVELATION 21:22-23**

3. Twelve tribes on the gates, twelve apostles on the foundations.

The gates carry the names of the twelve tribes of Israel. The foundations carry the names of the twelve apostles of the Lamb (Revelation 21:12-14). Both houses, Judah and Joseph, have their names on the city, and *the nations will walk in its light* (Revelation 21:24). Everyone who enters comes in through a gate named for a tribe of Israel. That is what it means to be grafted in: one city, one people, one King.

4. The gates never close, and nothing profane enters.

> *Its gates will in no way be shut by day (for there will be no night there), and they shall bring the glory and the honor of the nations into it so that they may enter. There will in no way enter into it anything profane, or one who causes an abomination or a lie, but only those who are written in the Lamb's book of life.*
> **REVELATION 21:25-27**

In the ancient world a city shut its gates at night because of enemies. These gates never shut, because there is no night and there are no enemies left. But that open door is also a holy door. Only those written in the Lamb's book of life enter.

5. The river, the tree, and no more curse.

> *He showed me a river of water of life, clear as crystal, proceeding out of the throne of Elohim and of the Lamb, in the middle of its street. On this side of the river and on that was the tree of life, bearing twelve kinds of fruits, yielding its fruit every month. The leaves of the tree were for the healing of the nations. There will be no curse any more. The throne of Elohim and of the Lamb will be in it, and his servants will serve him. They will see his face, and his name will be on their foreheads. There will be no night, and they need no lamp light or sun light; for Adonai Elohim will illuminate them. They will reign forever and ever.*
> **REVELATION 22:1-5**

They will see his face. Moses was told *you cannot see my face, for man may not see me and live* (Exodus 33:20). In the New Jerusalem the curse is gone, death is gone, and his people see his face. That takes a different kind of body than the one we have now, which is exactly why this study has a part two.

> **A NOTE ON READING A VISION**
>
> Revelation is a vision, and John often sees things that represent something. The twelves and the measurements may well carry meaning beyond engineering numbers. But the direction of the vision is not symbolic at all, and the prophets confirm it again and again: **YHWH comes down to dwell with his people on the earth.**

SECTION IX

What This Changes Right Now

- **It changes how we pray.** *Your Kingdom come, your will be done on earth* (Matthew 6:10). We are not praying for an exit. We are praying for an arrival.
- **It changes how we live.** *Everyone who has this hope set on him purifies himself* (1 John 3:3). Nothing profane enters the city (Revelation 21:27). A people headed for the Holy of Holies walk in holiness now. *Don't be conformed to this world, but be transformed by the renewing of your mind* (Romans 12:2).

- **It changes how we treat the earth and its people.** YHWH has not written off the world he made. Neither should we. The nations are invited to walk in that light.
- **It changes how we grieve.** The tears are real now. But the One who sits on the throne has promised to wipe every one of them away himself (Revelation 21:4).
- **It changes how we forgive.** No bitterness, no grudge, and no curse will cross those gates. Humility is the root of forgiveness, and forgiveness is the root of deliverance. Start living like a citizen of that city today.
- **It changes how we keep the feasts.** Every Sukkot is a rehearsal of Revelation 21:3, the day the tabernacle of Elohim is with people.

SECTION X

Walking It Out This Week

Practical, testable, and small enough to actually do. Seven days.

1 **Pray the Kingdom down.** Pray Matthew 6:10 slowly each morning and ask YHWH what his will on earth looks like in your home today.

2 **Read the bookends.** Read Genesis 2 and 3, then Revelation 21 and 22, in one sitting. Write down every match you find.

3 **Trace the tabernacle.** Read Exodus 25:8, Leviticus 26:11-12, Ezekiel 37:21-28, John 1:14, and Revelation 21:3 aloud. Hear the same promise five times.

4 **Purify yourself.** Ask YHWH to show you one thing that would not pass through those gates, and lay it down (1 John 3:3).

5 **Forgive one specific thing.** Name it, release it, and take it off the list. Bitterness has no address in the New Jerusalem.

6 **Bless the earth.** Do one practical act of care for someone or something in your community, as a citizen of the coming Kingdom.

7 **Tell someone the direction.** Share this with one person: we are not going up and away. He is coming down and in.

SECTION XI

Word Study Reference

katabainō G2597 καταβαίνω To come down, descend. Used of the New Jerusalem in Revelation 3:12; 21:2, 10.

skēnē / skēnoō G4633, G4637 σκηνή, σκηνόω Tent, tabernacle; to pitch a tent, dwell. John 1:14; Revelation 21:3. Septuagint name of Sukkot: ἑορτὴ σκηνῶν.

kainos G2537 καινός New in kind or quality, renewed. Revelation 21:1, 5; 2 Corinthians 5:17.

paradeisos G3857 παράδεισος Garden, park. Septuagint word for Eden's garden (Genesis 2:8); Revelation 2:7.

kataskēnōsis κατασκήνωσις Tabernacling, dwelling. Septuagint of Ezekiel 37:27.

palingenesia G3824 παλιγγενεσία Regeneration, the world born again. Matthew 19:28.

apokatastasis G605 ἀποκατάστασις Restoration, putting back in order. Acts 3:21.

politeuma G4175 πολίτευμα Citizenship, commonwealth. Philippians 3:20.

katoikeō G2730 κατοικέω To settle and dwell permanently. 2 Peter 3:13.

shakan / mishkan H7931, H4908 שכן, משכן To dwell, abide; the dwelling place, tabernacle. Exodus 25:8-9; Leviticus 26:11.

halak (hithpael) H1980 מתהלך To walk about, go to and fro. Genesis 3:8; Leviticus 26:12.

chadash / bara H2319, H1254 חדש, ברא New; to create. Isaiah 65:17; 66:22; Genesis 1:1.

YHWH Shammah H8033 יהוה שמה YHWH is there. The name of the city, Ezekiel 48:35.

SECTION XII

Cross Reference Index

The city comes down: Revelation 3:12; 21:1-5, 9-27; 22:1-5

Eden and paradise: Genesis 2:8-17; 3:8, 17-24; Revelation 2:7; 22:2-3

The dwelling thread: Exodus 25:8-9; 29:45-46; Leviticus 26:11-12; 1 Kings 8:27; Ezekiel 37:15-28; 43:7; John 1:14; 2 Corinthians 6:16; Revelation 21:3

Sukkot: Leviticus 23:33-43; Zechariah 14:16-19; John 7:2

Isaiah: Isaiah 2:2-4; 11:9; 25:8; 54:11-12; 60:11, 19-20; 65:17-25; 66:1, 22

Ezekiel: Ezekiel 40:2; 43:7; 47:1-12; 48:30-35

Daniel: Daniel 2:34-35, 44; 7:18, 22, 27

The minor prophets: Joel 3:17-18; Habakkuk 2:14; Zechariah 2:10-11; 8:3; 14:4-9, 16

The Psalms and the Torah: Numbers 14:21; Psalm 37:9, 11, 29; Psalm 115:16

Yahshua's teaching: Matthew 5:5; 6:10; 19:28; 24:29-31, 36; John 14:2-3

The apostles: Acts 1:11; 3:21; Romans 8:19-23; Galatians 4:26; Philippians 3:20-21; Hebrews 11:10, 13-16; 12:22; 13:14; 2 Peter 3:6-13; 1 John 3:2-3

The order of events: Matthew 24:29-31; 1 Thessalonians 4:16-17; Revelation 20:1-15; 21:1-2

The bride: Revelation 19:7-9; 21:2, 9; Ephesians 5:25-32

The Most Holy Place: 1 Kings 6:20; Exodus 33:20; Revelation 21:16, 22

> **KEEP GOING: PART TWO**
>
> *The Resurrection: Our Glorified Bodies* picks up where this study ends: what our bodies will be like when we live in the city, and how Yahshua's own risen body shows us. Also see *We Do Not Go Up* for where the dead are now.

NOTES

Personal Notes and Convictions

Walk in truth. Walk in Light. Shalom.

Kingdom Life Ministry
Restoring YHWH's design for marriage, family, forgiveness, and deliverance.